Jan. 26

I wonder if I'll ever get used to addressing the joint session of Congress. I've made a million speeches in every kind of place to every kind of audience. Somehow there's a thing about entering that chamber, goose bumps and a quiver. But it turned out fine. It was well received and I think the speech was a four base hit.

Jan. 28

. . . the press is trying to paint me as now trying to undo the New Deal. I remind them I voted for FDR four times. I'm trying to undo the "Great Society." It was LBJ's war on poverty that led us to our present mess. . . . I hope I'm not getting too optimistic but several economic indicators have turned upward indicating that maybe the recession has bottomed out. The market staged the sharpest rise since last March.

Feb. 22

Lunch on issues. I'm convinced of the need to address the people on our budget and the economy. The press has done a job on us and the polls show its effect. The people are confused about economic program. They've been told it has failed and it's just started.

Feb. 23

Met this a.m. with our [Republican] Congressional leaders. They are really antsy about the deficit and seem determined that we must retreat on our program —taxes and defense spending. Yet they seem reluctant to go for the budget cutting we've asked for. . . .

March 26